

Virtual Private Networking: Top Product Recommendations

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Virtual Private Networking products are great tools for businesses who need to ensure their network connections are encrypted and secure regardless of where their endpoints are located. They also reduce the expense of companies having to establish a point-to-point connection between locations and allow them to focus on their organization. In selecting the best VPN product for an organization, there are many different security features and qualities that need to be considered. Some of the security factors include quality encryption, administrative management, DNS protection, and much more. This paper will compare, discuss and recommend the top VPN products on the market.

Some of the top VPN products on the market include Perimeter 81, GoodAccess, ExpressVPN, Windscribe, VyprVPN, NordVPN, and more. Some of the different characteristics to consider when comparing VPN products are speed, encryption, ease of usage, gateway locations provided, administration controls, etc. Perimeter 81 is considered the number one recommendation in comparison to the VPN products listed. It offers 256-bit encryption, is easy to use, has over 700 servers in 36+ locations internationally, and makes managing teams of employees easier. Compared to some of the other products, it is considered more expensive. Similar to Perimeter 81, GoodAccess has great administrative controls and options to allow for secure and easy management of user accounts and activity. It also provides new security strategies to protect traffic outside the network and split tunneling. Unfortunately, it does not offer as many gateway locations as Perimeter81. ExpressVPN is known for its first-rate encryption, diverse geographical support with VPN locations in 94 countries, high speed, and 24/7 customer service. Similar to Perimeter81 and GoodAccess, it is considered more expensive. Windscribe, VyprVPN, and NordVPN are all well known for having great encryption and

business/enterprise management services. Out of the three, Windscribe is considered way more cost-effective for businesses as it has free and paid versions of its product available (*Keary, 2022*).

There are various security features that are included in VPN products and should be prioritized when selecting the best one for the organization. Connection obfuscation is when the VPN providers disguise VPN traffic as normal Internet traffic. This is helpful for clients who may be stationed in areas where VPNs are not legal. Another key security feature is a kill switch. VPN kill switch protection is when the provider will kill the internet connection if there is a disconnect from the VPN servers to ensure online activities are not open to monitoring by the outside (*Hawk, 2019*). Some other important features include DNS leak protection, firewalls, multi-factor authentication, split tunneling, a privacy-first logging policy, and multi-hop servers. Each of these security features provides the organization with extra layers of security and prevents the opportunity for outside intentions to view/access sensitive information.

Taking into consideration the important security features, services, and reasonable costs the top three VPN products best for the organization include GoodAccess, Windscribe, and NordVPN. First, GoodAccess has over 35 worldwide gateway locations and a great administration control panel with full control of access points on each system which allows admin to see who logs in and when to monitor suspicious activity. It also offers secure company resources, servers, databases, multi-factor authentication, single sign-on, split tunneling, and site-to-site protection (*GoodAccess, n.d.*). Next, Windscribe is a great VPN option because it has servers across 63 countries (and 110 cities), is the most cost-effective, blocks IPs and malvertising on all devices, has very strong encryption, configs all devices using Open VPN, IKEv2, and WireGuard and has desktop application features. It also offers static IPs, port

forwarding, split tunneling, and a diverse range of browser extensions (*windscape, n.d.*). Lastly, NordVPN has over 5500 servers in 58 countries, offers great speed, unlimited bandwidth, 24/7 customer support, and offers IP protection. This product has great security features such as password management, threat protection against malware, web trackers, and blocks ads. In addition, it has military-grade encryption, a verified no-logs policy, DNS leak protection, an automatic kill switch, and a file encryption tool (*NordVPN, 2022*).

In sum, each company has different needs and should evaluate what their company prioritizes in a VPN product. There are many different products available on the market, but there are a few that provide quality security and service. Each of the top three VPN products are great recommendations for an organization but it boils down to if a company is willing to invest in bandwidth, more security features, a larger geographical range, or administrative control. GoodAccess, Windscribe, and NordVPN offer great services that overlap while some of their strengths are more obvious than others.

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